essentials, hired a Matador van from a neighbour and went to Mridula's brother's house in the Shanthi Oliver Church campus, where he was the pastor.[15]

The situation was now a ticking time bomb. The DGP's office had passed on Ranganath's address to the commissioner of police in Bangalore. The city police had reached Ranganath's house in Putanahally. Apparently, his landlord, E. Anjanappa, had gone there to find out if what he had heard was true—that his tenant had sublet the house to Sri Lankans. But Ranganath had left minutes ago. Anjanappa heard about the Matador. Seeing the police at his doorstep, the landlord gave the police the details of the vehicle from his neighbour. The police stayed put for the Matador van to return.[16]

The driver was back in the afternoon. By evening the police had picked up Mridula from her brother's house and taken her to Jaya Nagar police station in Bangalore. When asked about her husband Ranganath, she said she would speak to the commissioner of police, Bangalore, and no one else. Shortly, the DCP Crime of Bangalore arrived, posing as the commissioner of police. To that Mridula reiterated that she had asked for the commissioner of police and no one else. Shortly, B.P. Ramalingam, the commissioner of police, arrived at the Jaya Nagar police station. By the late evening of 18 August, Mridula began describing her experiences of the past sixteen days with Rajiv Gandhi's killers to a stunned city police.[17]